Lex Situs: In-Depth Strategy & Execution Report

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This comprehensive report expands upon the initial assessment of Lex Situs, providing a deep dive into the business model economics, a recalculated market scale, an actionable $^{90}/_{180}$-day execution plan, a detailed competitor comparison, a 3-year financial model, talent acquisition strategies, funding requirements, and community engagement tactics within the UK PropTech ecosystem.

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1. Business Model Deep Dive & Unit Economics

Lex Situs employs a sophisticated "negative marginal cost" hybrid model spanning three stages: CapEx (Ingestion), OpEx (SaaS), and Data Licensing. To validate this, we modeled standard B2B SaaS unit economics against Lex Situs's proposed pricing.

Assuming an average high-density building of 150 units and approximately 9,000 sqm total floor area, the three revenue streams generate the following per-building economics:

Revenue Stream	Pricing Input	Per Building (£)	Nature
Stage 1 — Ingestion (CapEx)	£4 / sqm × 9,000 sqm	36,000	One-off
Stage 2 — SaaS (OpEx)	£120 / unit / year × 150 units	18,000	Recurring
Stage 3 — API / Data Licensing	Insurers + Valuers combined	5,000	Recurring
Steady-State Annual Recurring Revenue		**23,000**	**Recurring**

Assuming a Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) of £25,000 per building via direct enterprise sales, a 7-year retention life, and a 78% gross margin, the unit economics comfortably clear investor benchmarks [1]:

Metric	Value	Benchmark
Average Year-1 Contract Value (Ingestion + SaaS)	£54,000	—
Annual Recurring Revenue per Building	£23,000	—
Gross Margin	78%	> 75% healthy
CAC (direct enterprise sales)	£25,000	—
Lifetime Value (7 yrs × ARR × GM)	£125,580	—
LTV : CAC	**5.0 : 1**	**≥ 3 : 1 healthy**
Payback Period	16.7 months	12–18 months acceptable for enterprise PropTech

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2. Market Scale Recalculation (TAM/SAM/SOM)

The pitch deck's TAM calculation (£10B+ based on service charges and deposits) is conceptually flawed from an investor's perspective, as Lex Situs does not capture that entire spend. A more accurate calculation is based on the number of target buildings multiplied by the Lex Situs pricing model.

Using official Building Safety Regulator (BSR) data of 12,777 registered Higher-Risk Buildings (HRBs) in the UK [2], we can reconstruct TAM/SAM/SOM on a bottom-up basis:

Segment	Scope	Buildings	Annualised Value (£M)
TAM — UK HRB recurring	12,777 HRBs × £23k ARR	12,777	**£293.9M**
TAM — incl. ingestion (5-yr amortised)	Adds £7.2k/yr ingestion per building	12,777	**£385.9M**
SAM — London Tier-1 clusters	53,000 units ÷ 150 u/bldg	353	**£8.1M**
SOM — 3 signature partnerships	5,500 units ÷ 150 u/bldg	37	**£0.85M**

Recommendation: Update the pitch deck to reflect this "bottom-up" calculation. Investors prefer a realistic £385M highly-penetrable niche TAM over an inflated £10B theoretical TAM.

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3. Competitor Comparison Matrix

Lex Situs must clearly differentiate itself from existing reality capture and construction management platforms.

Feature / Metric	PlanRadar [3]	OpenSpace [4]	Buildots [5]	Matterport [6]	Lex Situs
Core Value	All-in-one task & defect management	AI 360° capture & progress tracking	AI progress tracking vs. BIM	3D digital twins (marketing/commercial)	**4D Spatial Registry + UPRN Indexing**
Capture Method	360° camera / Mobile	360° hardhat camera	Hardhat camera	Pro3 Camera / Mobile	**Visual SLAM + Mobile + 360°**
BIM Integration	Supported	Strong (Autodesk, Revizto)	Deep BIM comparison	Limited	**BIM-anchored 3DGS**
Task Management	Built-in	Requires 3rd party (Procore)	Requires 3rd party	Requires 3rd party	**Built-in (Surveyor Portal)**
Post-Handover O&M	Partial	Weak	Weak	Medium	**Core Design Focus**
Statutory Golden Thread	No	No	No	No	**Yes (Unique Moat)**
Pricing Model	Subscription	ACV-based (Annual Construction Vol)	Project-based subscription	£/cloud space	**One-off £/sqm + Annual £/unit + API**

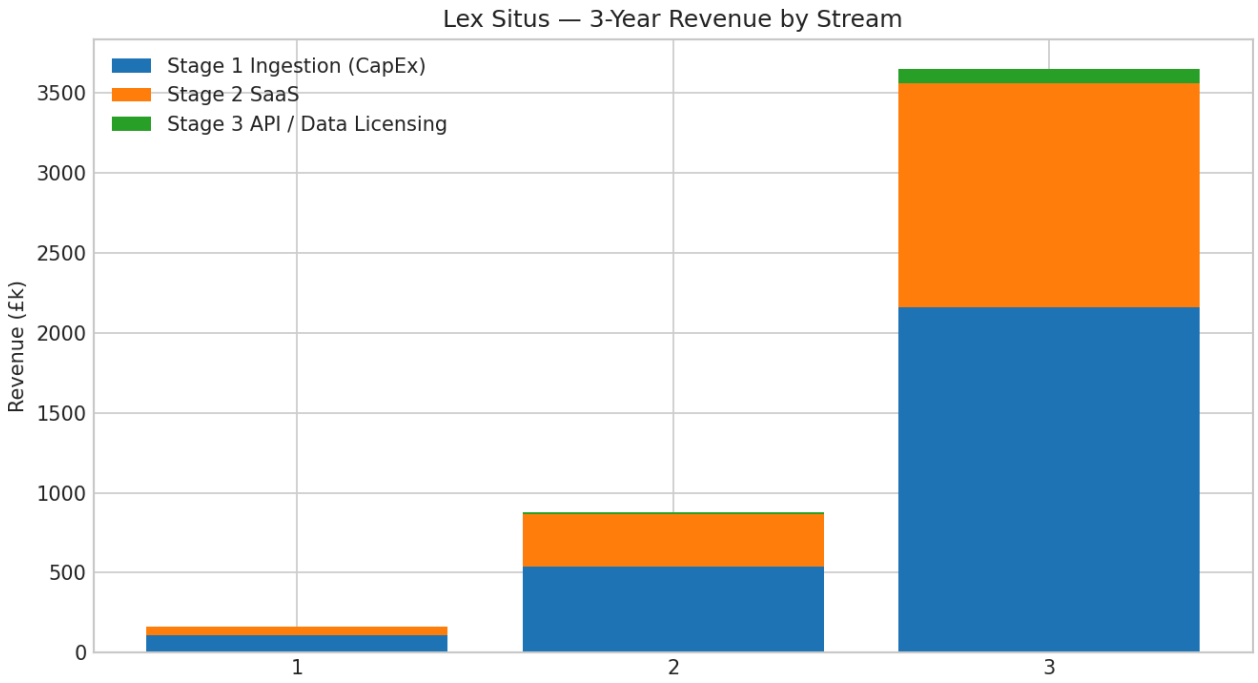
Strategic Takeaway: Lex Situs wins by owning the *post-handover liability gap*. OpenSpace and Buildots are tools for the General Contractor during construction. Lex Situs is an infrastructure asset for the Developer, Property Manager, and Insurer for the entire lifecycle.

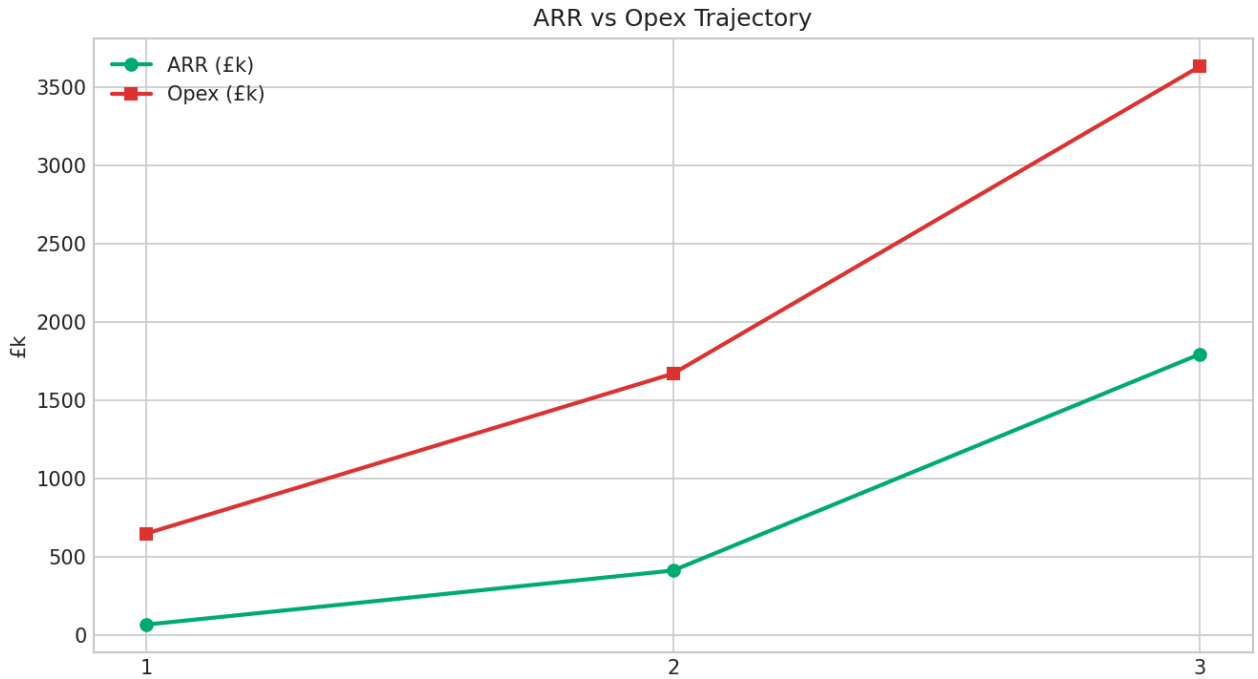
4. Financial Model & 3-Year Trajectory

Based on the £500k Pre-Seed ask, we modeled a 3-year trajectory targeting Series A metrics (£1.5M+ ARR):

£ thousands	Year 1 (Pre-Seed)	Year 2 (Seed)	Year 3 (Series A prep)
New buildings onboarded	3	15	60
Cumulative buildings	3	18	78
Ingestion revenue	108	540	2,160
SaaS revenue	54	324	1,404
API / Data licensing revenue	0	15	90
Total revenue	**162**	**879**	**3,654**
ARR (end of year)	**69**	**414**	**1,794**
Personnel	510	1,190	2,380
Cloud & rendering	60	180	450
GTM & operations	80	300	800
Total operating cost	**650**	**1,670**	**3,630**
Net burn	**(488)**	**(791)**	**+24**
Avg. monthly burn	41	66	breakeven

The model indicates that the £500k Pre-Seed provides approximately 12 months of runway at the modelled Y1 burn; a £1.5M–£2M Seed round in month 10–12 is critical to sustain the Y2 scaling phase.





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5. Talent Acquisition Strategy

To execute this roadmap, specific talent profiles are required at each funding stage.

Pre-Seed (Months 1–12): The Core Builders

- **Founder/CEO (Janet Nien):** Capital markets, compliance, enterprise sales.

- **CTO / Lead Spatial Engineer (Crucial Hire):** Must have deep expertise in 3D Gaussian Splatting (3DGS), Visual SLAM, and cloud infrastructure. Do not hire a generic web developer; you need a computer vision specialist.
- **Full-Stack Engineer:** To build the Layer 1 (Mobile) and Layer 2 interfaces and the Surveyor Portal.
- **BIM / VDC Manager (Part-time/Consultant):** To ensure the ingestion pipeline correctly parses IFC/RVT files.

Seed (Months 13–24): Scaling Operations

- **Head of Sales (PropTech):** Someone with a Rolodex of BTR operators (Greystar, Get Living).
- **Customer Success Manager:** To ensure the 3 signature partners successfully adopt the MVP.
- **Data Engineer:** To begin structuring the API for the Stage 3 Data Licensing model.

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6. Funding Requirements & Milestones

The UK early-stage funding landscape in $^{2025}/_{2026}$ demands strong traction. The median UK Pre-Seed round is £395k, and the median Seed round is £1.58M [7].

- **Current Ask (£500k Pre-Seed):** This is a highly appropriate and slightly aggressive ask. Assuming a standard 15–20% equity dilution, this implies a £2.5M–£3.3M post-money valuation, which aligns perfectly with the UK average Pre-Seed valuation of £3.2M [8].
- **Milestone to unlock Seed (£1.5M - £2M):** Investors will want to see the 3 MVP buildings fully ingested, active usage by property managers, and at least £250k–£400k in contracted ARR.
- **Milestone to unlock Series A (£5M+):** Proven negative churn (NRR > 110%), £1.5M+ ARR, and the first successful API data licensing contract signed with a major insurer.

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7. Actionable $^{90}/_{180}$-Day Execution Plan

First 90 Days:

1. **Close the Round:** Finalize the £500k Pre-Seed. Leverage SEIS/EIS advance assurance to attract UK angel investors.

2. **Hire the CTO:** Secure the technical co-founder or Lead Spatial Engineer.
3. **Lock in Pilot #1:** Sign a Letter of Intent (LOI) with one of the 3 signature developers for a single-floor "Pre-Seal" pilot.

First 180 Days:

1. **MVP Delivery:** Successfully execute the Visual SLAM capture on the pilot floor and render the 3DGS model anchored to the BIM framework.
2. **Surveyor Portal V1:** Launch the basic interface for auditors to drop metadata pins onto the 3D model.
3. **Grant Applications:** Apply for non-dilutive funding, specifically the Innovate UK Smart Grant (£25k–£700k) [9], positioning Lex Situs as a deep-tech solution for building safety.

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8. Community, Networking, and Resource Acquisition

To succeed in the UK PropTech and RegTech ecosystem, Lex Situs must embed itself in the right networks.

Accelerators & VC Networks:

- **Pi Labs:** The premier PropTech VC in London. Apply for their 12-week Growth Programme [10].
- **REACH UK:** Backed by Second Century Ventures, highly relevant for real estate tech scaling [11].

Industry Associations (The Buyers):

- **Association for Rental Living (ARL) & British Property Federation (BPF):** These are the ultimate buyers (BTR operators). Attend their quarterly forums [12].
- **Golden Thread Initiative / Get It Right Initiative (GIRI):** Join the GIRI Technology Working Group. This is where the actual compliance standards are being written by the industry [13].

Events for Visibility:

- **Digital Construction Week (DCW) London 2026:** Exhibit or secure a speaking slot in the "Innovation in the Built Environment" track [14].
- **BSR Stakeholder Engagement Forums:** Attend Building Safety Regulator webinars and conferences to stay ahead of compliance nuances and network with early adopters [15].

References

[1] HelloMrLead. (2025). CAC in B2B SaaS 2025: Benchmarks. [2] WhatDoTheyKnow. (2025). Building Safety Regulator data - a Freedom of Information request. [3] PlanRadar. (2025). 360° Construction Photo Documentation Software: PlanRadar vs. OpenSpace vs. Buildots. [4] OpenSpace. (2026). Pricing & Products. [5] PlanRadar. (2025). Buildots Comparison. [6] Matterport. (2026). Subscription Plan Pricing. [7] Adam French. (2026). UK Pre-Seed and Seed Rounds: Median and Percentile. [8] Equidam. (2025). UK Startup Funding 2025: A Guide for Early-Stage Founders. [9] Innovate UK. (2025). Smart Grants. [10] Pi Labs. (2025). Growth Programme. [11] Second Century Ventures. (2025). REACH UK 2025 Cohort. [12] BPF. (2026). Build-to-Rent report - Q1 2026. [13] Get It Right Initiative. (2026). GIRI Technology Working Group meeting. [14] Digital Construction Week. (2026). Events & Exhibitions. [15] UK Government. (2025). BSR webinars empower hundreds of stakeholders.

Appendix · Supplementary Documents

Lex Situs: Strategic Supplements

Author: Manus AI
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This document contains three critical supplements to accelerate Lex Situs's execution: a targeted Job Description for the Chief Technology Officer (CTO), an application strategy for the Pi Labs Growth Programme, and a conceptual API Licensing Term Sheet for insurers.

Supplement A: Chief Technology Officer (CTO) / Lead Spatial Engineer Job Description

To build the "4D Spatial Registry," Lex Situs requires a technical leader with deep expertise in computer vision, not just standard web development.

Position: Co-Founder & CTO / Lead Spatial Engineer

Location: London, UK (Hybrid) **Compensation:** £80,000 – £100,000 + Significant Equity (Co-Founder level)

The Mission: Lex Situs is building the "Golden Thread" of building information. We use Visual SLAM and 3D Gaussian Splatting (3DGS) to create immutable, UPRN-indexed spatial registries for high-density residential buildings, ensuring compliance with the Building Safety Act 2022. We are looking for a technical visionary to build the infrastructure that turns physical buildings into searchable 4D assets.

What You Will Build (The 180-Day Roadmap):

- **The Ingestion Engine:** Architect the pipeline that takes raw 360°/mobile video from construction sites and uses Visual SLAM to anchor it to existing BIM (IFC/RVT) coordinates.
- **The 3DGS Rendering Layer:** Implement a low-latency 3D Gaussian Splatting viewer that runs smoothly on mobile browsers for property managers (Layer 1 & 2).
- **The Immutable Ledger:** Design the backend architecture to securely store and timestamp metadata (the "Golden Thread") against specific spatial coordinates (GUIDs).

Who You Are:

- **Computer Vision Expert:** You have hands-on experience with Visual SLAM (e.g., ORB-SLAM, RTAB-Map) and photogrammetry/NeRFs/3DGS. You know how to align 2D imagery into a 3D coordinate space.
- **Cloud & Rendering Architect:** You understand how to deploy heavy rendering workloads on AWS/GCP and serve lightweight outputs to edge devices (WebGL/WebGPU).
- **BIM/Spatial Data Familiarity (Bonus):** Experience parsing IFC files or working with spatial databases (PostGIS) is a massive plus.
- **Zero-to-One Builder:** You are comfortable writing the first lines of code, making foundational architectural choices, and eventually recruiting and leading a world-class engineering team.

Supplement B: Pi Labs Growth Programme Application Strategy

Pi Labs is Europe's most active early-stage PropTech VC. Their 12-week Growth Programme is highly competitive. Lex Situs must position itself not just as a "SaaS tool," but as a systemic solution to a £10B+ regulatory crisis.

Key Narrative Pillars for the Application:

1. **The Regulatory Urgency (The "Why Now"):**
    - *Message:* "The Building Safety Act 2022 has made the 'Golden Thread' a legal requirement, but the industry is trying to solve a 4D problem with 2D PDFs. We are the compliance engine for the new era."
    - *Proof Point:* Highlight the Gateway 2 bottleneck and the massive fines developers face for non-compliance.
2. **The Negative Marginal Cost Model (The "Why Us"):**
    - *Message:* "Unlike traditional BIM tools that are cost centers, Lex Situs becomes a revenue-generating asset. We charge developers to ingest the data, charge property managers to host it, and license it to insurers for pure profit."
    - *Proof Point:* Emphasize the LTV:CAC ratio of 5.0 and the transition from CapEx to recurring SaaS/API revenue.
3. **The UPRN Moat (The "Defensibility"):**
    - *Message:* "We aren't just stitching photos together like OpenSpace. We are indexing spatial data to the UK's standardized Unique Property Reference Number (UPRN). We are building the sovereign digital record of the asset."
4. **The Ask from Pi Labs:**
    - *Message:* "We have the regulatory tailwind and the technical blueprint. We are applying to Pi Labs to access your unmatched network of Build-to-Rent (BTR) operators and institutional asset managers to secure our first 5,500 units."

Supplement C: API Data Licensing Term Sheet (Conceptual)

This is a conceptual framework for the Stage 3 revenue stream: licensing the 4D Spatial Ledger to an insurer (e.g., Aviva, Zurich) to reduce structural ambiguity and accurately price premiums.

HEADS OF TERMS: Spatial Data API Licensing Agreement

1. Parties:

- **Licensor:** Lex Situs Ltd.
- **Licensee:** [Name of Tier-1 UK Property Insurer]

2. Purpose of License: To grant the Licensee API access to the Lex Situs "4D Spatial Registry" for the sole purpose of underwriting, risk modeling, and claims verification for properties actively managed on the Lex Situs platform.

3. Data Provided (The "Golden Thread" Payload):

- Verified "As-Built" spatial records (Pre-Seal structural imagery).
- Timestamped O&M logs and defect reports anchored to spatial GUIDs.
- Fire safety metadata (location of dry risers, fire doors, gas shut-offs).
- *Note: All data is anonymized regarding resident PII; focus is strictly on structural integrity.*

4. Commercial Terms (The Pricing Model):

- **API Access Fee:** £5,000 per building, per annum.
- **Revenue Share / Premium Arbitrage (Alternative Option):** In lieu of a flat fee, Lex Situs receives 15% of the net reduction in the annual insurance premium generated by the de-risking of the asset via the Lex Situs platform.

5. Licensee Obligations:

- Licensee agrees to offer a "Verified Spatial Data Discount" on premiums for developers/asset owners who utilize Lex Situs, thereby incentivizing market adoption (The Flywheel Effect).

6. Intellectual Property:

- Lex Situs retains all ownership of the spatial index, the 3D models, and the aggregated metadata. Licensee is granted a non-exclusive, non-transferable right to query the data for risk pricing.